

Grok Bot vs Muse vs Dots: Which Makes Money?

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Oct 01, 2026 · Watch: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gC_i1CYc8Ww Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Brandon Carter stress-tests Grokbot, Meta Muse, and OpenAI Dots as AI employee-style agents for real business tasks — CRM deals, sales-call review, Instagram lead follow-up, and trading bots — concluding Muse wins on value despite Grokbot's flexibility and Dots' deep ChatGPT context.

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Framing: AI Agents as Employees, Not Toys 0:00

- Brandon's core thesis: treat these bots like employees who must generate income, not novelty gadgets
 - "If we just wanted to have fun with these things, you're better off just getting a PlayStation."
 - He criticizes other YouTube coverage for focusing on inbox triage and calendar management — useful but not monetization-focused
- The evaluation framework is a **job interview**: which tool can take work off his plate AND magnify income-generating output?
- He runs a 30-person fully remote team using Slack as the central hub
- He is a self-described Codex power user — does 85% of his work, including video editing, inside ChatGPT Codex
 - Bought the \$500 Codex plan within an hour of it being announced
 - Also bought the \$200 ChatGPT Codex keyboard despite public ridicule
- Original plan was only to compare Muse vs. Grokbot; OpenAI dropping Dots mid-production forced a three-way comparison
- His mental model for the three tools:
 - Grokbot → Department Head (multiple specialized bots on separate missions)

- Muse → Executive Assistant (personal + business, Meta-integrated)
- Dots → Chief of Staff (deep ChatGPT/Codex context, proactive initiative)

Pricing & Credit Economics 2:38

- **Grokbot:** starts at \$20/month; Brandon is on the \$100/month plan and still rations credits
 - Credits deplete fast with real workloads — "I feel like if I say the word Grokbot too many times, I'm going to run out of credits for the week"
 - You can purchase additional credits beyond the plan
- **Muse:** free tier available — Brandon emphasizes this repeatedly as a major differentiator
 - He upgraded to a higher paid tier for heavy usage; even so, on his \$60/month plan he had only used ~60 cents of tokens midweek with many tasks running
 - Dramatically cheaper per unit of work compared to Grokbot
 - Before Muse launched, he was constantly topping up Grokbot with extra money
- **Dots (OpenAI):** requires at minimum the \$100/month ChatGPT plan; Brandon is on the \$500/month plan
 - Critical issue: Dots runs on **Astra**, OpenAI's most expensive model — you cannot switch models as of filming
 - Draws from your entire ChatGPT credit pool, so recurring background tasks can silently drain credits needed for Codex work
 - Brandon's view: Soul 6.1 would be more than capable for most Dots use cases; using Astra feels like a deliberate strategy to accelerate credit consumption
- Key principle: sticker price is only one variable — compare cost against finished jobs and actual income generated

Context & Memory: What Each Bot Knows 3:49

- **Grokbot:**
 - You define a role for each bot; each bot has its own memory and its own tools
 - Bots can share files with each other
 - Controversy over whether each bot gets a dedicated virtual computer or they share one — Brandon's experience suggests they share
- **Meta Muse:**
 - Has memory files that persist preferences and history
 - Memory can be updated manually
 - Has its own dedicated virtual computer
 - Native access to Instagram and Facebook data (followers, interactions, demographics, DMS)
- **Dots (OpenAI):**
 - Has its own virtual computer

- Pulls from ALL of your ChatGPT conversation history and Codex context
- "It already knew what was going on with me. As soon as I set it up, it started making moves on my behalf."
- This is especially powerful for Codex power users — it knows every project, tool, and workflow



Grokbot Deep Dive: Department-Head Setup 4:38

- Brandon runs multiple specialized bots; two are in his permanent "favorites":
 - **Chief of Staff bot** — orchestrates everything, runs overall operations
 - **Project Manager bot** — tracks and manages ongoing projects
- **Subscription Auditor bot:**
 - Monitors his email for active subscriptions that should be cancelled
 - Because Grokbot has its own computer and is already logged in, it can actually navigate to those sites and unsubscribe automatically
- **Dealbot** (CRM management):
 - Hooked into GoHighLevel CRM
 - No native GoHighLevel integration exists for Grokbot, so he worked around it:
 - Used a service called **AgentMail** (designed to give AI agents their own email addresses)
 - Created a Grokbot-specific email address via AgentMail
 - Added that email as an employee inside GoHighLevel
 - Now Grokbot can log into the CRM and manage deals directly
 - Monitors new leads and tracks their journey through the sales pipeline
 - As salespeople fail to close, it helps manage follow-up sequences
- **Sales Call Reviewer bot:**
 - When a sales call comes in, the bot pulls the transcript automatically
 - Reviews the call against Brandon's defined sales criteria and salesperson training standards
 - Produces a summary report on call performance
 - Brandon: "As a sales manager, this has made my job so much easier"
 - Limitation: the tool used to record sales calls did NOT have a Muse connector at the time, so this remained a Grokbot-exclusive workflow
- **Stock Trading bot:**
 - Set up an Agentic (AI-managed) account on Robinhood
 - Deposited \$1,000 and handed control to Grokbot
 - Still in testing — "let's see if Grokbot can actually keep his spot on my roster"
- All three tools integrate with Slack, but Brandon notes one does it better (covered in Dots section)
- Bot "groups" and "teams" feature in Grokbot's desktop app: Brandon dismisses this as a gimmick

- "I don't want it wasting credits having conversations with other agents. You are all the same thing. Just get the job done."



Meta Muse Deep Dive: Free Personal + Business Powerhouse 7:41

- Brandon named his Muse avatar "Tyrone" — customized to an African-American hip-hop robot aesthetic instead of the default furry Monsters Inc. creature
- **Instagram analytics use case:**
 - Because Muse has native Meta integration, it can directly access Instagram account data
 - Brandon asked it to analyze his Instagram — it returned: follower count, interaction rates, demographic breakdown (mostly US), what strategies are working, what to do more of, what to stop
 - He then analyzed a competitor's account (Greg from Knobody's Instagram) — that account had roughly 2x his numbers on every metric
 - Muse broke down the competitor's full content strategy
 - Asked Muse to write more scripts like his best-performing Reels — it generated scripts that subsequently performed well
- **Instagram DM lead recovery use case:**
 - Set up a dedicated chat whose only job is to follow up on leads that went cold
 - Prompt: "Give me a list of leads that may have fallen through the cracks like 90 days ago"
 - Muse searched through his Instagram DMs from 90 days back and surfaced actual hot leads
 - Offered to draft re-engagement messages for each one
 - Messages can be reviewed and sent directly from the Muse interface with one "Allow" confirmation
 - Brandon: "If you get one extra client from it, it was worth it" — and it's free
- **Polymarket Trading bot:**
 - Muse is logged into Polymarket on its own virtual computer and actively trading
 - Running total at time of filming: **41 cents** profit — acknowledged with humor
- **Personal assistant use case** (consumer-grade):
 - Saw on Brandon's calendar that a friend's daughter's 4th birthday party was coming up
 - He forgot to buy a gift; told Muse: "This chick is four. Figure out the best toy and buy it."
 - About an hour later, the gift arrived at his home — fully autonomous purchase
 - Also looked up what watch Zuckerberg was wearing at Meta Connect: a **\$112,000 watch**
- **GoHighLevel integration** (new, discovered day of filming):
 - Muse just launched an official GoHighLevel connector — something Grokbot still lacks natively
 - Brandon's reaction: "I could use Muse for everything now"
- **Slack integration:** also newly added — Brandon can now route Muse into his team Slack workspace
- **Cost efficiency:** on his \$60/month Muse plan vs. \$100/month Grokbot plan, Muse delivers far more usage per dollar

"Out of the two, if I had to pick one, I'm picking Muse over Grokbot. It's official."

OpenAI Dots Deep Dive: Chief of Staff in Codex 13:04

- Brandon only received access the night before filming — less than 24 hours of experience at time of recording
- Lives inside Codex as a persistent dot icon; customizable color (Brandon chose purple)
- **Immediate proactive behavior:**
 - On first launch, it detected a to-do item on his calendar and handled the entire task without being asked
- **Skills extraction task:**
 - Prompt: "Find all the skills I use to edit videos and make content. Download them from Codex. Put them in a folder. Create a document explaining what they're used for and how to use them. Upload everything to Google Drive."
 - Dots completed all steps in a single prompt — files appeared in Google Drive
- Key observation: Dots takes initiative in a way the others don't — proactively identifying and acting on tasks rather than waiting
 - Counterpoint noted: he saw another creator say Dots was NOT good at taking initiative — his experience was the opposite, but he acknowledges 24 hours is limited data
- Can do nearly everything the other tools can do EXCEPT trading on Robinhood
 - Attempted to set up Robinhood trading: Dots refused — "I can't make trades for you"
 - Grokbot has no such restriction
- **Slack integration:** Dots can be added directly to Slack
 - Can DM team members from Brandon's Slack account (or optionally from its own account)
 - Brandon considers this one of the better Slack implementations among the three
- **The model cost problem:**
 - Dots runs on Astra (OpenAI's most powerful and expensive model)
 - No option to switch to a cheaper model like Soul 6.1, which Brandon argues would handle 99% of Dots use cases
 - Suspicion: intentional design to burn through credits and force monthly top-ups
 - Risk: background recurring tasks silently consume the same credit pool used for all Codex work

Interface & Access Comparison 15:47

Tool	Mobile	Desktop	Other Access
Grokbot	Good mobile app	Desktop app with bot groups/teams	—

Tool	Mobile	Desktop	Other Access
Muse	Excellent Muse app	Excellent desktop app	WhatsApp (Brandon finds it unnecessary)
Dots	ChatGPT mobile app	ChatGPT web, Codex, ChatGPT Work	Slack (strong integration)

- Grokbot's "bot groups" desktop feature: Brandon calls it a gimmick — agents talking to each other wastes credits
- Muse's WhatsApp access: available but Brandon doesn't find it useful
- Dots' Slack bot: most capable Slack integration of the three in Brandon's assessment; can DM teammates and act on behalf of the user

Verdict: Which One to Pick 16:56

- Brandon's current stance: using all three simultaneously while still in testing
- If forced to choose one: **Muse wins**
 - Free to start, dramatically cheaper per task at scale
 - Native Meta/Instagram integration is unique and directly monetizable
 - New GoHighLevel and Slack integrations close the gap with Grokbot's business capabilities
 - Strong personal assistant capabilities (autonomous purchasing, calendar awareness)
- Grokbot stays on the roster ONLY IF the Robinhood Agentic trading account generates meaningful returns from the \$1,000 deposit
 - Its flexibility (no restrictions on what it will do) is its key differentiator
 - Biggest weakness: expensive and credit-hungry
- Dots is promising but the Astra model cost structure is a serious concern
 - Best suited for existing ChatGPT/Codex power users who already have the \$100+ plan
 - Its proactive, context-rich behavior is genuinely impressive
 - Cannot trade on Robinhood (a hard restriction)
- Final ranking summary:
 - Best value / best for most people → **Muse** (free, Meta-integrated, improving fast)
 - Best for complex multi-bot business workflows → **Grokbot** (if budget allows)
 - Best for Codex power users → **Dots** (if you can manage the credit cost)